

THE NO-VIG CHEAT SHEET

Every two-sided price tells you two things: what the book charges, and what the market actually thinks. They are not the same number. This is how you get from one to the other.

THE ONLY TWO FORMULAS YOU NEED

1. American price to implied %

Negative: $\text{imp} = -\text{odds} \div (-\text{odds} + 100)$ $-110 \quad 110 \div 210 = 52.4\%$
 Positive: $\text{imp} = 100 \div (\text{odds} + 100)$ $+150 \quad 100 \div 250 = 40.0\%$

2. Strip the cut to the true number

fair % = your side's implied % $\div$ (both sides' implied % added together)
 Both sides -110 : $52.4 + 52.4 = 104.8$. $52.4 \div 104.8 = 50.0\%$. A coin flip, priced as 52.4%.

WHAT THE COMMON PRICES REALLY COST

PRICE	BREAK-EVEN %	FAIR % vs -110	THE BOOK'S CUT
-105	51.2%	50.0%	2.4 cents
-110	52.4%	50.0%	4.8 cents
-115	53.5%	50.0%	7.0 cents
-120	54.5%	50.0%	9.1 cents
+100	50.0%	48.8%	—
-200	66.7%	64.5%	—

KEY NUMBERS — WHY HALF A POINT MATTERS

NFL margins land on 3 and 7 more than any other number. Buying off 3 to 2.5, or 7 to 6.5, is worth far more than the same half point anywhere else. College spreads the distribution wider, but 3, 7, 10 and 14 still cluster.

+3.5 and +3 look almost identical on a board. Then the favorite wins by exactly three — one ticket cashes, the other pushes. That is the whole argument for watching the number instead of the team.

READING A LINE MOVE IN FOUR CASES

Number moves toward a side AND that side's price rises

Money and the number agree. The strongest read you get.

Number moves toward a side but that side gets cheaper

The number outran the money that pushed it. A fade setup.

Number frozen, price on one side keeps climbing

The market is out of room on the number, so it moves the price instead.

Both sides juiced (-118 / -118)

The book does not want either side at this number.

We run this math on every game, every morning — free.

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